



Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Let's review!



Learning Outcome

Accurately use information about people's backgrounds in a wider variety of communicative situations.

Ask your partner:

- How would you help a friend or family member make an important decision?
- Do you think there are times when a person should make their own decisions without any help? When?

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about feelings, reactions, and decision-making.
- I can explain opinions and encourage agreement.
- I can speculate about things and express possibility and necessity.





Let's Explore!

Vanessa is **optimistic*** about a new beginning at work!

* The opposite of "optimistic" (feeling positive) is pessimistic.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

- Sally:** So, how did it go with the owner?
- Vanessa:** I don't think it went as well as I hoped. I'm a bit discouraged but I'm going to keep an open mind. I was going to just forget about it but I'm trying to stay optimistic.
- Sally:** What did he say? Didn't he like your concept? I want to know if he listened to you.
- Vanessa:** Yes, he listened and he must like the idea a bit. We're supposed to have another meeting about it next week.
- Sally:** So you think he's agreeable to your plan. That's great!
- Vanessa:** He's not impulsive so he's going to take some time to mull it over. He really didn't say much.
- Sally:** But you think that he is considering it. So that's really encouraging! You have got to be proud of yourself.
- Vanessa:** Yeah, I am. And he did say that he might want to renovate the restaurant and he put me in charge of that.
- Sally:** Congratulations! You seem to be great at that!
- Vanessa:** Yeah, I think I will. But I'd like to bounce some decorating ideas off of you before I take the plunge and order new furniture and paint!
- Sally:** Of course! You don't want to make any hasty decisions about decorating. That could be very costly. You have to weigh your options very carefully.
- Vanessa:** I'm optimistic! It's going to be like working in a brand new restaurant!





Let's Practice!

Sally shares her feelings.

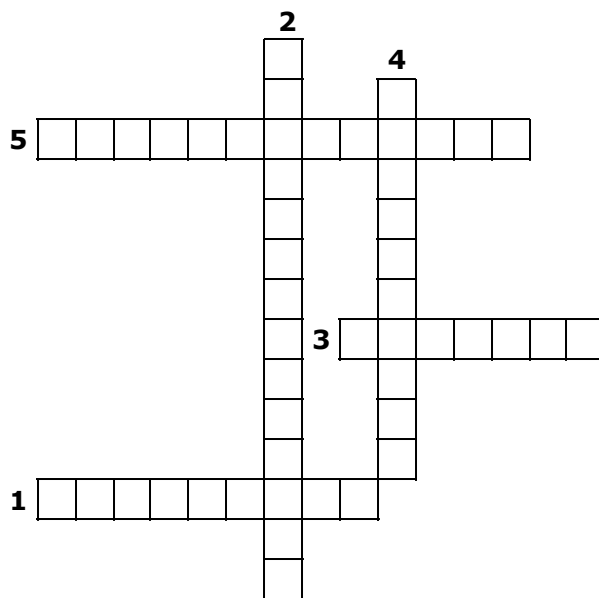
Instructions: Complete the crossword.

DOWN

2. To be open and listen to all the ideas and opinions about something
4. To take time for thinking about a problem or situation carefully

ACROSS

1. Acting quickly without giving things much of a thought
3. A structured idea that has been thought over beforehand
5. To suddenly commit oneself to something



Let's Practice!

Sally tells Vanessa her opinions.

Instructions: Complete the sentences with the words you think fit coherently.

1. So _____ the owner is agreeable to your plan. That's great!
2. _____ your concept? I want to know if he listened to you.
3. Congratulations! You _____ at proposing new ideas.
4. But you think that the owner is considering your proposal. So that's really _____!
5. _____ very open minded about new ideas? I think he'll like your proposal.

Word Bank

- encouraging
- Isn't he
- you think
- Didn't the owner like
- seem to be great





Extension Activity

Role play a career counseling session.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Imagine that you are considering a change to a completely different career or job.
- Write down at least three reasons that you want to make this change.
- Role play a conversation with a career counsellor who will ask you questions to help you make a decision. Your partner will be the career counselor.
- The career counselor needs to be prepared to ask questions that will help the employee make the right decision.
- Change roles with a partner and repeat the activity.

Self-Assessment

Yes No

I talk about feelings, reactions and decision-making.

☐ ☐

I explain my opinions and encourage agreement.

☐ ☐

I speculate about things and express possibility and necessity.

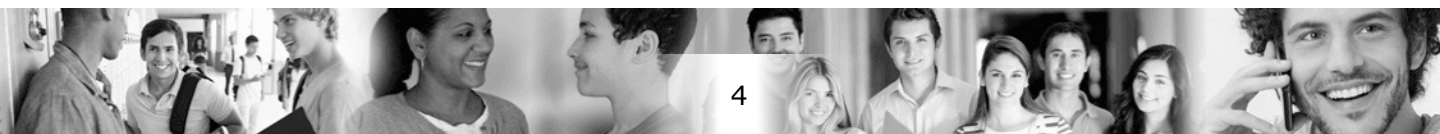
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I role play a career counselor and employee.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- to weigh one's options** (expression): to consider options in order to judge which one is the best one
e.g. You don't want to make any hasty decisions about decorating. That could be very costly. You have to weigh your options very carefully.
- hasty** (adjective): moving or acting very fast without paying much attention or thinking things over
e.g. You don't want to make any hasty decisions about decorating.
- to keep an open mind** (expression): to be open and listen to all the ideas and opinions about something
e.g. I don't think it went as well as I hoped. I'm a bit discouraged but I'm going to keep an open mind.
- concept** (noun): a structured idea that has been thought over beforehand
e.g. What did he say about changing the style of the restaurant? Didn't he like your concept?
- impulsive** (adjective): acting quickly without giving things much of a thought
e.g. He's not impulsive so he's going to take some time to mull it over.
- to mull over** (expression): to take time for thinking about a problem or situation carefully
e.g. He's not impulsive so he's going to take some time to mull it over.
- to bounce ideas off** (expression): to tell someone about an idea in order to know that person's opinion
e.g. I'd like to bounce some decorating ideas off of you before I order new furniture and paint!
- to take the plunge** (expression): to suddenly commit oneself to something
e.g. I'd like to bounce some decorating ideas off of you before I take the plunge and order new furniture and paint!





Learning Points

Explaining and Organizing Your Opinions, and Encouraging Agreement

You use words like *think* and *seem* to express your opinions and questions to encourage agreement.

You use phrases like:

- *I think ...*
- *You seem ...*
- *It seems ...*

to explain your opinion.

Example:

You seem to be great at that!

You use questions and questions within sentences to encourage agreement.

Example:

Didn't he like your concept?

So you think he's agreeable to your plan.

Examples:

- *Didn't he like your concept?*
- *So you think he's agreeable to your plan.*
- *But you think that he is considering it. So that's really encouraging!*
- *I don't think it went as well as I hoped.*
- *You seem to be great at that!*
- *I don't think it went as well as I hoped.*





Learning Points

Modals for Speculation, Possibility and Necessity

When you speculate about something, you are making a guess based on what you know about the situation.

You use modals when you want to express possibility and necessity.

You can show you are speculating about something by using a modal, like *must*, *might*, *may* or *could*.

The modal verb is followed by the main verb in the base form. You do not use "to". Do not add "ing", "ed", or "s" to the verb.

Example: He **must like** the idea a bit.

You use *may*, *might* and *could* to express possibility in the past and in the future.

**Might* suggests that something is less possible than *may*.

- *might* / *might not* + infinitive
- *could* / *could not* + infinitive
- *may* / *may not* + infinitive

Example: He *might want to renovate the restaurant*.

Expressing Necessity

You use *must* or *have to* to express that something is necessarily true.

Examples:

- *You have got to be proud of yourself.*
- *He must like the idea a bit.*
- *He might want to renovate the restaurant.*
- *That could be very costly.*
- *You have to weigh your options very carefully.*

